

Miyamoto wanted a more modular hardware, something that could suit multiple purposes at minimal cost. The Wiimote thus has an expansion port for accessories. The Nunchuk, one such accessory, comes bundled with the Wii and is integral to enjoying FPS games and traditional software that require an analogue stick. The Nunchuk, too, houses accelerometers, but cannot be used as a pointer. This allows for some cool games such as boxing, wherein the Nunchuk can act as your left glove, and the Wiimote as your right glove, and you can box onscreen as you would in real life. Boxing, as part of *Wii Sports*, allows you to throw punches and even allows you to evade your opponent's punches by swaying your body left and right!

Another unique element to the Wii remote is the speaker. Of passable quality, the speaker does add a bit of aural feedback to a game: for example, it can output the sound of ball hitting racquet in a tennis game, the sound of a gun shooting and reloading in an FPS, or the sound of you reeling in your line in a fishing game. This

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The Nunchuk (left) adds to the fun of the Wiimote

apart, the Wiimote has the usual force feedback for a more tactile experience.

Finally, the Wiimote comes with 4 KB of onboard memory. This is used to store a user's personal settings and his or her personal avatar, dubbed Mii, of course, which can be created using the console.

## Channel Wii

Nintendo extended the Wii Remote's TV metaphor to the realm of "channels." As hardware meant for the entire family, Wii offers more than *just games*: each avenue of entertainment/information is presented as a thumbnail channel by the Wii. Apart from the Disc Channel, where you can play both Wii and GameCube titles, Wii has the Mii Channel where you can create avatars of yourself (which later

appear in some games), a News Channel, a Forecast Channel, a Photo Channel, a Wii Shop Channel, an Internet Channel, and channels for each Virtual Console title.

While most of these channels are self-explanatory, notable among them are the Photo Channel, which displays your camera's photos and movies via an SD slot on the Wii. The Photo Channel also allows you to do some rudimentary editing to your pictures and videos, create slideshows, and play MP3 music to a slideshow. The Internet Channel is essentially the Opera Web browser optimised for the Wii and TV screen display (note that the maximum resolution the Wii can display in is 480p, or 720 x 480).

The Wii Shop is where you can buy additional games or content for your purchased games: the Wii will be able to play games from several old consoles, under its so-called Virtual Console feature—the NES, the SNES, the N64, the Mega Drive/Genesis, the TurboGrafx-16, the Commodore 64, and perhaps others not yet announced. You will also be able to purchase several brand-new games as well.

Most of these games will require you to purchase a "Classic Controller" peripheral. Each of these games will cost certain "Wii Points"—an NES title for 500 points, an N64 for 1000, a Mega Drive for 800, and so on—with 500 Wii Points being equivalent to \$5.

Games downloaded from the Wii Store will appear as Virtual Console channels (a channel each for each game by default, although they can be grouped together) and can either be stored on the Wii's 512 MB of internal Flash memory or to an external SD card. The console will keep track of your purchases, so you can delete a purchased title and later download it for free. Each Virtual Console title will be locked to the Wii it has been purchased on; you cannot take these games on an SD card and play them on a friend's Wii.

## ConnectiWiiti

Out of the box, the Wii can communicate wirelessly via 802.11b/g. You can otherwise separately purchase a USB-to-Ethernet dongle if you don't have a wireless router. Nintendo hasn't shared its online libraries with third parties, and online multiplayer support isn't expected to arrive until early next year, at least from third parties. Meanwhile, two games announced—*Mario Strikers Charged* and *Battalion Wars 2*—support multiplayer over the Internet as well as locally. *Battalion Wars 2*, or *BWii*, will feature online assault, skirmish, co-op play, and four-player capture-the-flag.

Apart from local and Internet connectivity, the Wii can also communicate with the Nintendo DS. It has been suggested that the DS' touch screen will be used to interact with characters on the TV. At least one game—*Pokémon Battle Revolution*—has been noted as using this feature when it is launched later this year in Japan: not only can you import your Pokémon from the Diamond and Pearl DS version, you will be able to control the entire game using the DS alone. You can use the DS stylus to select attacks, targets, view status, switch out Pokémon, and